

VMware expands open source presence by joining Linux Foundation

After supporting the open source world passively for a long time, VMware has finally joined the Linux Foundation as a Gold member. This will help the company become an active player in the open source community. "The open



source community will benefit from VMware's wealth of talent and resources, as we collaborate to solve technology challenges from the data centre to cloud infrastructure and beyond," said Jim Zemlin, executive director, the Linux Foundation, in a joint statement.

VMware has already contributed to some Linux Foundation projects such as Open Network Automation Platform (ONAP), Cloud Foundry and Open vSwitch. This has apparently brought the Dell subsidiary closer to the open source world. "VMware looks forward to working more closely with the open source community, and we know this involvement will enable ever better solutions and services for our customers," stated Dirk Hohndel, vice president and chief open source officer, VMware.

The Gold members of the Linux Foundation include Accenture, Blackrock, Citrix, Doki, Facebook, Hart, Panasonic, SUSE, Toshiba and Toyota. Semiconductor manufacturer Renesas became a Gold member recently.

This is not the first time that VMware has leaned towards open source. The Palo Alto, California-headquartered company started favouring community efforts in the enterprise-focused market with the release of its vSphere integrated container code. In January 2017, VMware even partnered with the Linux Foundation for its Open-Object project. That partnership was primarily aimed at constructing the future of network functions virtualisation (NFV).

MySQL 8 to bring massive improvements

MySQL 8 is just around the corner. This new version promises to fix all the shortcomings of MySQL 5.7, which has been in use as the latest version for over a year.

Considering the number of optimisations and changes, MySQL 8 is advanced enough to bump directly from the MySQL 5.7 release. The new version does not come with a file system's maximum number of files that limit the number of databases you can use.

MySQL 8 will allow users to store millions of tables in a particular database. The new MySQL will also simplify the hassle of making alterations to these tables.

NASA releases code that was used for major scientific discoveries

While travelling into space is still a dream for most of us, you can now access the code that has powered major scientific discoveries related to space exploration. NASA has initiated this development by releasing its latest online software catalogue of more than 1,000 code descriptions.

The third edition of the annual software catalogue provides access to codes based on general public releases, open source releases, US and foreign releases, and US government-purpose releases. There are categories such as business systems and project management, system testing, operations, design and integration tools, vehicle management, propulsion, crew and life support, and data and image processing.

"Software has been a critical component of each of NASA's mission successes and scientific discoveries," said Dan Lockney, NASA's Technology Transfer programme executive, in a statement. "In fact, more than 30 per cent of all reported NASA innovations are software," he added.

You can find the codes for some advanced drones and quieter aircraft



models from the available software catalogue. While the

code access is free, there are a variety of restrictions on some of the software solutions. You need to sign usage contracts with NASA or a government body to access most of the available codes. However, the open source material is provided through the online catalogue to support community efforts.

NASA started publishing its software catalogue online back in 2014. The prime aim is to broadly release code behind the space exploration and discoveries, to maximise the benefits to the world.